

1. What is Graphic Design?

Simple Definition

Graphic Design is the art of creating visual content (images, text, colors, and shapes) to communicate a message.

In simple words,

Graphic Design = Making information look attractive and easy to understand.

Think about:

- Chocolate wrappers 🍫
- Movie posters 🎬
- YouTube thumbnails ▶ □
- Instagram posts 📱
- Company logos 🏢
- Visiting cards 📇

All these are created using **Graphic Design**.

Real-Life Example

Suppose your school is organizing a **Sports Day**.

Instead of writing:

Sports Day on 20 August. Come Everyone.

A graphic designer creates:

🏆 BIG SPORTS DAY

📅 20 August

🕒 9:00 AM

📍 School Ground

With colorful backgrounds, sports icons, and attractive fonts.

Why Do We Need Graphic Design?

Imagine reading a book with:

- No headings
- No colors
- No pictures
- Only text

Boring, right?

Graphic design makes information:

- ✓ Attractive
- ✓ Easy to read
- ✓ Easy to remember
- ✓ Professional

Elements Used in Graphic Design

Graphic designers use:

- Images
- Colors
- Shapes
- Text
- Icons
- Lines
- Patterns
- Space

These combine together to create beautiful designs.

2. Applications of Graphic Design

Graphic design is used almost everywhere.

Let's explore.

1. Advertising

Companies advertise products using posters, banners, and social media ads.

Example:

Nike Shoes Poster

Samsung Mobile Advertisement

Pizza Offer Banner

2. Social Media

Instagram

Facebook

LinkedIn

Twitter (X)

YouTube Thumbnail

Every post you see is designed.

Example:

Sale 50% OFF

Happy Diwali

Happy Birthday

Festival Wishes

3. Education

Schools use graphic design for:

Notes

Presentations

Certificates

Timetables

Notices

Question Papers

4. Business

Businesses create:

Company Logo

Business Cards

Invoices

Brochures

Catalogues

Flyers

5. Website Design

Every website contains:

Buttons

Icons

Images

Backgrounds

Banners

6. Mobile Apps

Food delivery apps

Banking apps

Games

Shopping apps

All require graphic design.

7. Packaging Design

Look around your home.

Chocolate wrapper

Milk packet

Soap cover

Biscuit packet

Medicine box

Everything is designed.

8. Entertainment

Movie Posters

Album Covers

Gaming Posters

Cartoons

Animation

9. Event Management

Wedding Cards

Invitation Cards

Birthday Invitations

College Fest Posters

Seminar Posters

Sports Certificates

10. Digital Marketing

Facebook Ads

Instagram Posts

Email Banners

Website Ads

Promotional Posters

Summary of Applications

Area	Example
Education	Certificates
Business	Logos
Marketing	Posters
Social Media	Instagram Posts
Website	Banners
Mobile Apps	Icons
Packaging	Product Covers
Events	Invitation Cards

3. Basic Shapes in Graphic Design

Everything in graphic design starts with **simple shapes**.

Think of building a house using LEGO blocks.

Similarly, every design starts with shapes.

1. Circle (○)

Represents:

Unity

Friendship

Earth

Sun

Example:

Company logos

Buttons

Profile pictures

2. Square (□)

Represents:

Balance

Strength

Order

Example:

Instagram posts

Photo frames

Cards

3. Rectangle (□)

Most commonly used shape.

Examples:

Posters

Certificates

Banners

Websites

Books

4. Triangle (△)

Represents:

Direction

Growth

Warning

Mountains

Example:

Play Button ► □

Road Signs

5. Line

Lines connect things.

Can be:

Straight

Curved

Zigzag

Dotted

Used for:

Separating sections

Drawing

Creating borders

6. Oval

Used in:

Logos

Badges

Frames

Photo borders

7. Polygon

Shapes with many sides.

Examples:

Pentagon

Hexagon

Octagon

Used in modern designs.

8. Star

Used for:

Ratings

Awards

Achievements

Festivals

9. Arrow

Shows direction.

Examples:

Go Here →

Download ↓

Next →

10. Heart

Used for:

Love

Care

Health

Like Button ♥ ☐

Why Are Shapes Important?

Shapes help:

Organize information

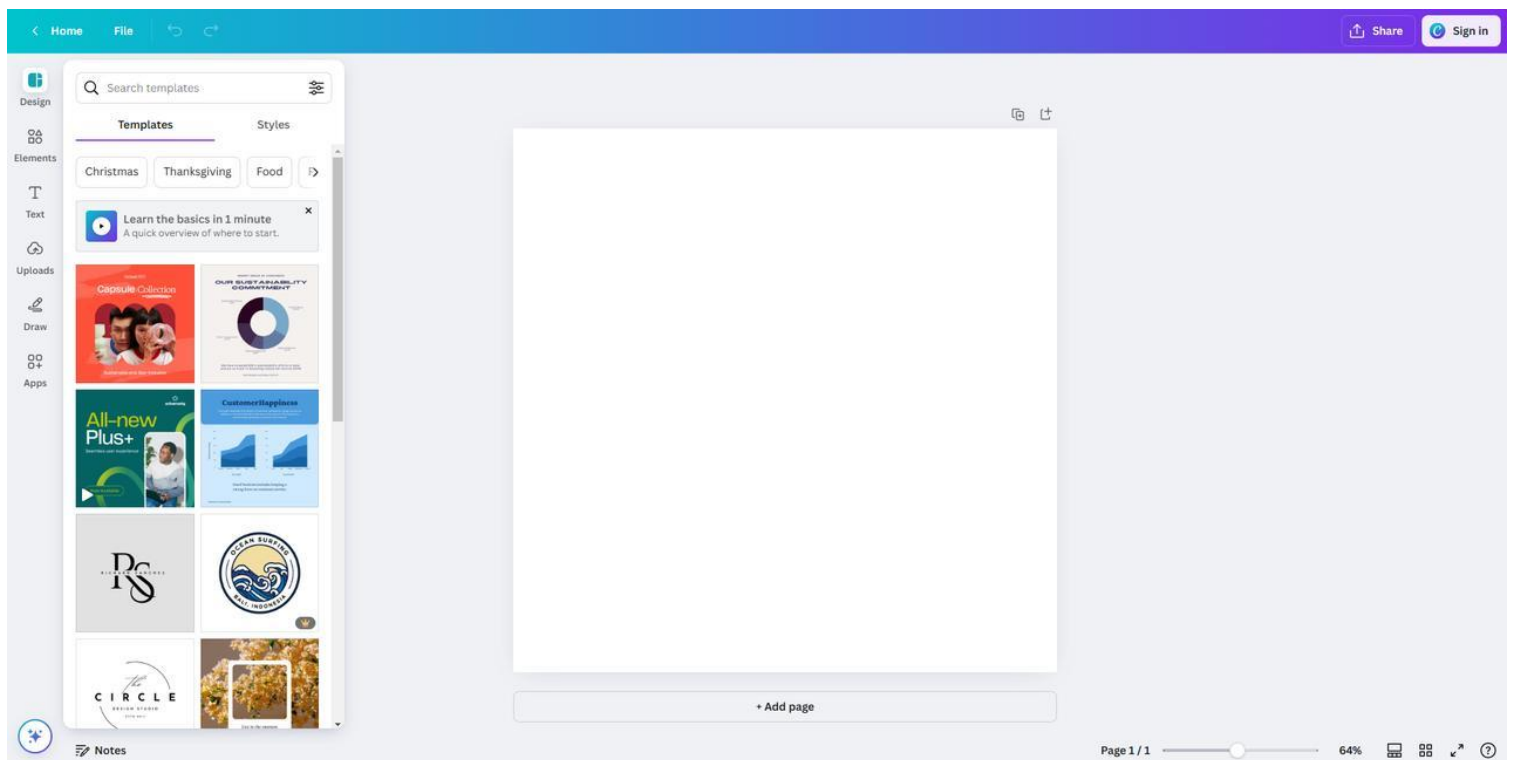
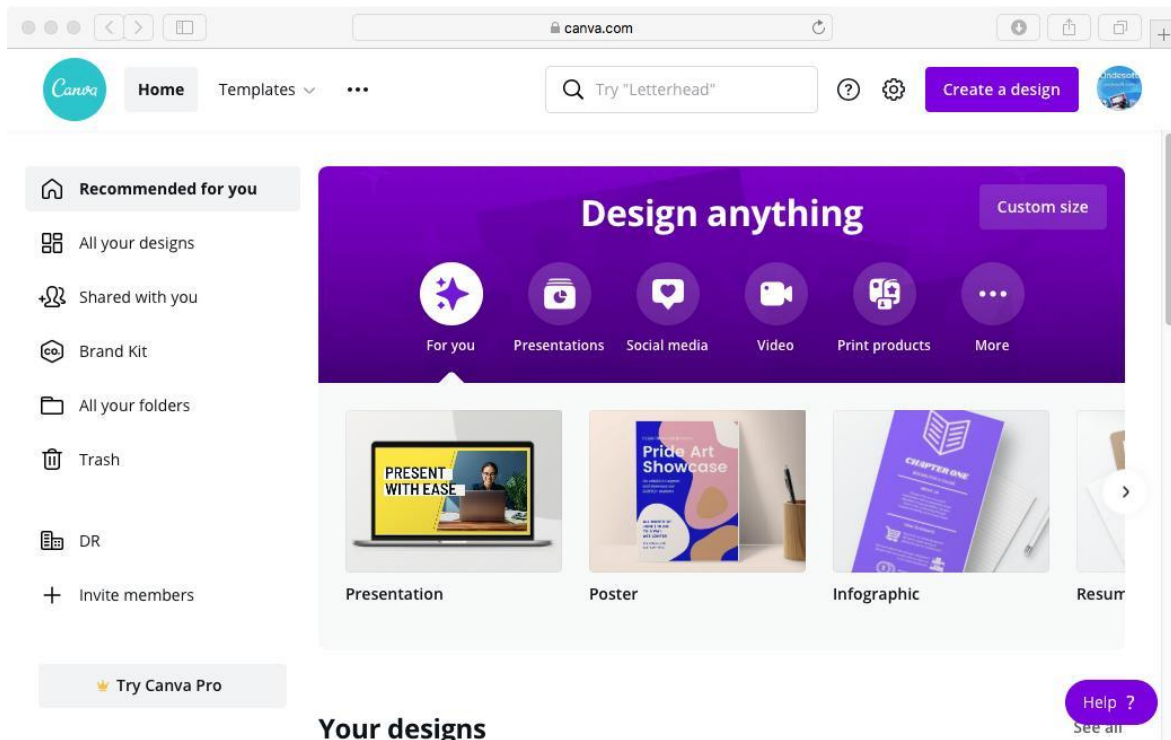
Create logos

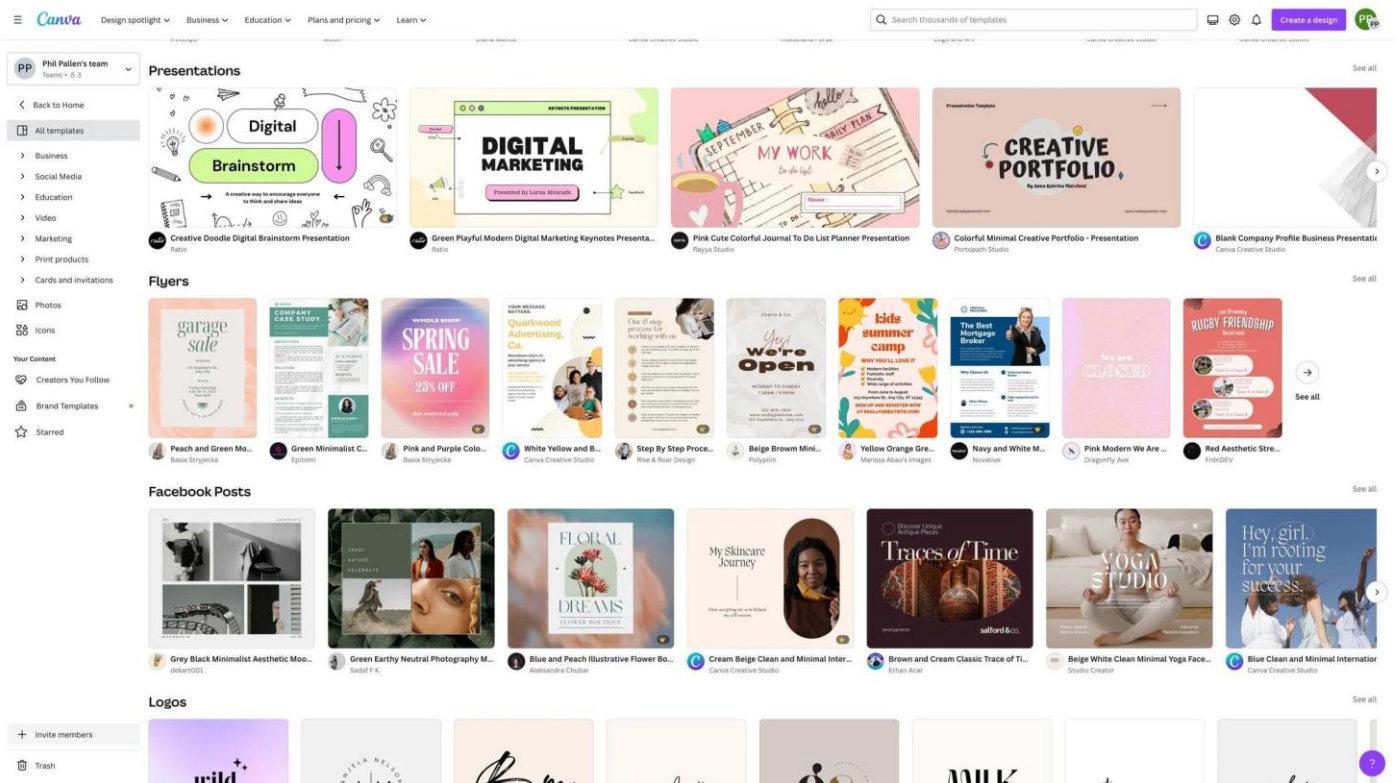
Decorate posters

Highlight text

Improve appearance

4. Overview of Canva





What is Canva?

Canva is an online graphic design tool that helps anyone create beautiful designs easily—without needing advanced design skills.

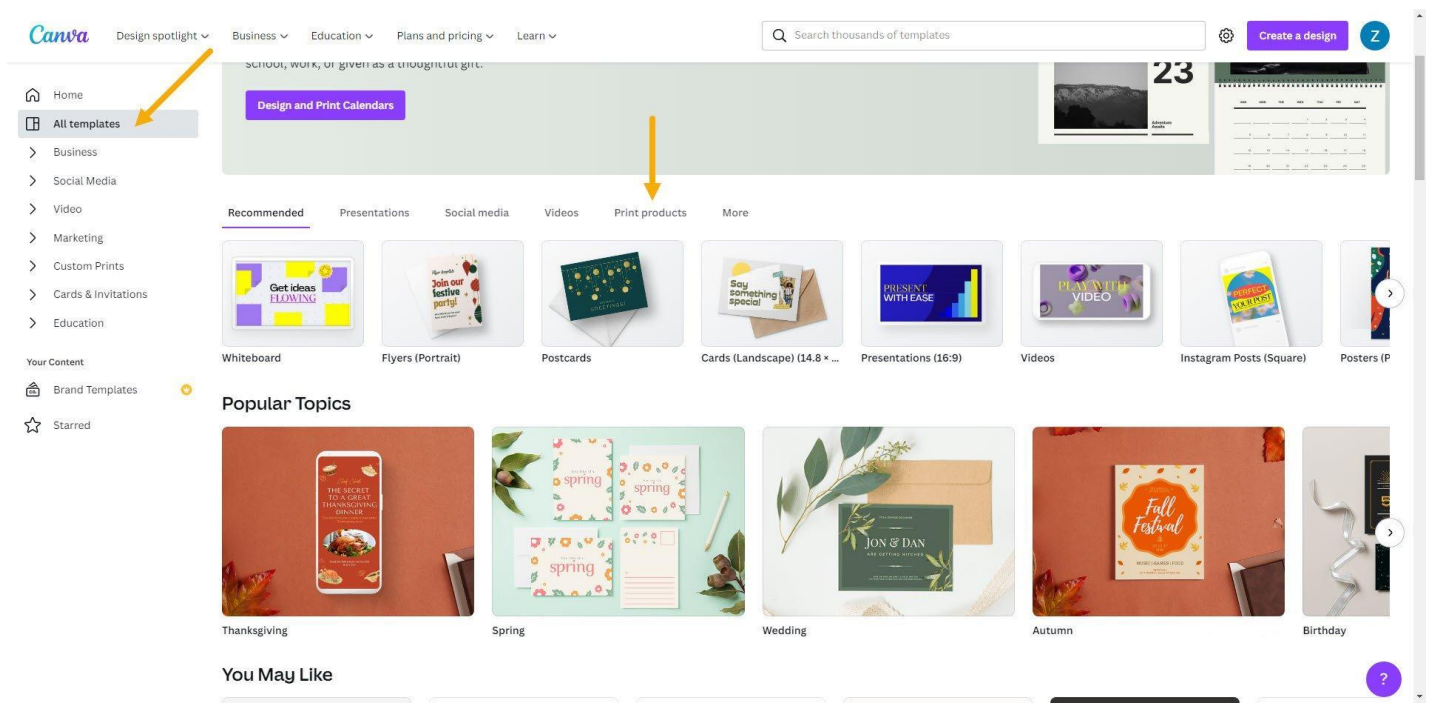
You can create professional designs simply by dragging and dropping elements.

Think of Canva as **Microsoft PowerPoint + Paint + Photoshop (Easy Version)**.

Features of Canva

- Ready-made Templates
- Drag-and-Drop Editing
- Thousands of Icons
- Millions of Photos
- Background Remover (Pro)
- AI Tools
- Charts
- Animations
- Video Editing

- Presentation Creation



Canva Can Create

Posters

Certificates

Resumes

Logos

YouTube Thumbnails

Instagram Posts

Facebook Posts

Business Cards

Invitations

Brochures

Presentations

Videos

Advantages of Canva

- ✓ Very easy to learn
- ✓ Free version available
- ✓ Works online
- ✓ Thousands of templates
- ✓ Professional-looking designs
- ✓ Saves time

5. Exploration of Canva Dashboard

When you open Canva after signing in, you will see several sections.

1. Home Page

This is the main dashboard.

It shows:

- Search bar
- Recent designs
- Templates
- Suggested designs
- Projects

2. Search Bar

Used to search for:

Poster

Logo

Resume

Presentation

Certificate

Instagram Post

3. Templates

Ready-made designs.

Instead of creating from scratch, simply choose a template and edit it.

Example:

Wedding Invitation

Birthday Poster

Resume

Certificate

Business Card

4. Projects

Stores all your saved work.

You can:

Open

Rename

Share

Delete

Download

5. Create a Design Button

Used to start a new project.

Examples:

A4 Document

Presentation

Poster

Flyer

Logo

Custom Size

6. Editor Workspace

This is where you actually create your design.

It includes:

Left Panel

- Templates
- Elements
- Text
- Uploads
- Photos
- Videos
- Audio
- Backgrounds

Center Canvas

Your working area where the design appears.

Top Toolbar

Contains:

Undo

Redo

Resize (Pro)

Share

Download

Present

7. Elements

Contains:

Shapes

Icons

Lines

Frames

Stickers

Charts

Illustrations

8. Text

Used to insert:

Heading

Subheading

Paragraph

Different fonts

9. Uploads

Upload your own:

Photos

Logos

Videos

Documents

10. Download Options

After finishing your design, you can save it as:

PNG

JPG

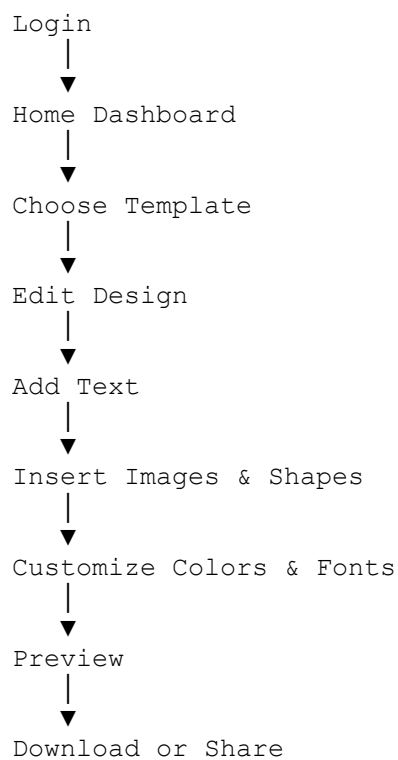
PDF

SVG (Pro)

MP4 Video

GIF

Canva Dashboard Flow



Quick Revision

Topic	Key Idea
Graphic Design	Creating visual content to communicate messages effectively.
Applications	Advertising, education, business, websites, apps, social media, events, and packaging.
Basic Shapes	Circle, square, rectangle, triangle, line, oval, polygon, star, arrow, and heart form the building blocks of designs.
Canva	A beginner-friendly online design platform with templates and drag-and-drop editing.
Canva Dashboard	Home, Search, Templates, Projects, Create Design, Editor, Elements, Text, Uploads, and Download options.

Remember

Graphic Design is about communicating ideas visually, and Canva makes it possible for beginners to create professional-looking designs quickly and easily.